



RVSR JOB AID

PTSD Ensure Proper Development (PEP-D) Checklist

Instructions: Complete the checklist as you review evidence in an eFolder for a Veteran's PTSD claim. It will help you determine if any evidence is missing or if further development is needed prior to rating a claim. Any time you check "No" to indicate that further development is needed, add what actions need to be completed in the Notes section at the end of the checklist.

Veteran's Name _____ SS# _____

Step I: Review Claim

1. What type of claim has been received (original, new, claim to reopen, etc.)?
2. What category of PTSD is being claimed (combat, noncombat, personal assault)?

Step II: Review Section 5103 Letter

Table 1: Section 5103 Checklist

Review Question	Yes or N/A	No
Did VBA inform the Veteran of all needed evidence, including sending a Section 5103 letter, if necessary?	☐	☐
If necessary, did the Section 5103 letter develop for stressor information?	☐	☐
If necessary, was the correct VA Form sent with the Section 5103 letter to develop for stressor information?	☐	☐

Step III: Review Evidence and Development

Table 2: Evidence Development Checklist

Review Question	Yes or N/A	No
Has the Veteran's service been properly verified?	☐	☐



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Review Question	Yes or N/A	No
Are the Service Treatment Records (STRs) complete and of record?	☐	☐
If the STRs are not of record, did VBA make the correct attempts to obtain STRs?	☐	☐
Are personnel records complete and of record?	☐	☐
If the personnel records are not of record, did VBA make the correct attempts to obtain personnel records?	☐	☐
Did VBA make appropriate attempts to secure DoD hospital/outpatient treatment records?	☐	☐
Did VBA make appropriate attempts to secure VA hospital/outpatient treatment records?	☐	☐
Did VBA make appropriate attempts to secure Vet Center hospital/outpatient treatment records?	☐	☐
Did VBA make appropriate attempts to secure private medical treatment records?	☐	☐
Did VBA make appropriate attempts to obtain lay evidence?	☐	☐

Step IV: Review Stressor Verification

Table 3: Stressor Verification Checklist

Review Question	Yes or N/A	No
Is stressor development required? (If no, proceed to Step V)	☐	☐
If necessary, did VBA request stressor corroboration from JSSRC, NARA, or MCASC? See M21-1 Part IV, Subpart ii.1.D – Where to send a request for corroboration of an in-service stressor.	☐	☐
If JSRRC, NARA, or the MCASC identified information needed before stressor corroboration could be completed, did VBA attempt to secure this information?	☐	☐
If additional information was acquired, did VBA forward it to JSRRC, NARA, or the MCASC for stressor corroboration?	☐	☐
If stressor verification required development to a service department(s) for a report of an incident, did VBA attempt to secure this information?	☐	☐



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Step V: Review Documentation of Evidence and Follow-up

Table 4: Documentation and Follow-up Checklist

Review Question	Yes or N/A	No
Did VBA properly document all requests for evidence?	☐	☐
If necessary, did VBA follow proper follow-up procedures IAW M21-1 Part I, Chapter 1 – Duty to Assist?	☐	☐
Did VBA properly document follow-up requests in the Veteran's eFolder, as appropriate?	☐	☐

Step VI: Review VA Exam Request

Table 5: VA Exam Request Checklist

Review Question	Yes or N/A	No
Was a VA exam necessary? (If no, proceed to Step VIII)	☐	☐
If a VA exam was necessary, was it ordered?	☐	☐
Was the C-file sent to the examiner for review prior to the exam; or, did the exam request notify the examiner to review the eFolder?	☐	☐
Personal assault claims only: If necessary, did the exam request ask for interpretation of secondary evidence IAW M21-1 Part IV, Subpart ii.1.D – Requesting examinations for PTSD claims based on MST?	☐	☐
Personal assault claims only: If necessary, did the request specifically ask for a gender-specific examiner as requested by the Veteran?	☐	☐

Step VII: Review PTSD DBQ

Table 6: PTSD DBQ Checklist

Review Question	Yes or N/A	No
If the Veteran failed to report (FTR) for the VA exam: was a copy of the notification of FTR of record in the Veteran's eFolder?	☐	☐



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Review Question	Yes or N/A	No
If the Veteran FTR for the VA exam: was the letter of notification of FTR mailed to the Veteran's most recent address?	☐	☐
Does the DBQ contain a diagnosis of PTSD?	☐	☐
Does the PTSD diagnosis include a multiaxial evaluation IAW DSM-5?	☐	☐
Did the examiner discuss a nexus between current symptoms and the in-service stressor?	☐	☐
If there are multiple diagnoses of mental disorders, are differentiations of symptoms noted?	☐	☐
Is an evaluation of the level of occupational and social impairment noted?	☐	☐
Did the examiner note that she/he reviewed the Veteran's eFolder prior to the exam?	☐	☐
Are there traumatic stressors noted that indicate they occurred in service?	☐	☐
Did the examiner note if the claimed stressor(s) are adequate to support a diagnosis of PTSD?	☐	☐
Did the examiner check all symptoms that actively apply to the Veteran's diagnosis?	☐	☐
If there was a conflict or change in diagnosis: Did the examiner explain the basis for the current diagnosis?	☐	☐

Step VIII: Confirm Claim Ready to Rate

a. Is claim ready to rate?

☐

Yes

☐

No

Table 7: Notes

Notes
Enter further development notes in the space provided.